Pembrolizumab + paclitaxel + carboplatin AUC6

Induction: all three medicines on Day 1 every 21 days for up to four cycles. Maintenance: paclitaxel and carboplatin stop; pembrolizumab alone may continue every 21 days while appropriate. The team agrees duration and review points.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Hormones / brain

Pembrolizumab

Unusual weakness, dizziness, headache, thirst or frequent urination: report promptly.

2 Lungs

Pembrolizumab

New cough or breathlessness needs prompt assessment; infection, cancer or clot can look similar.

3 Heart

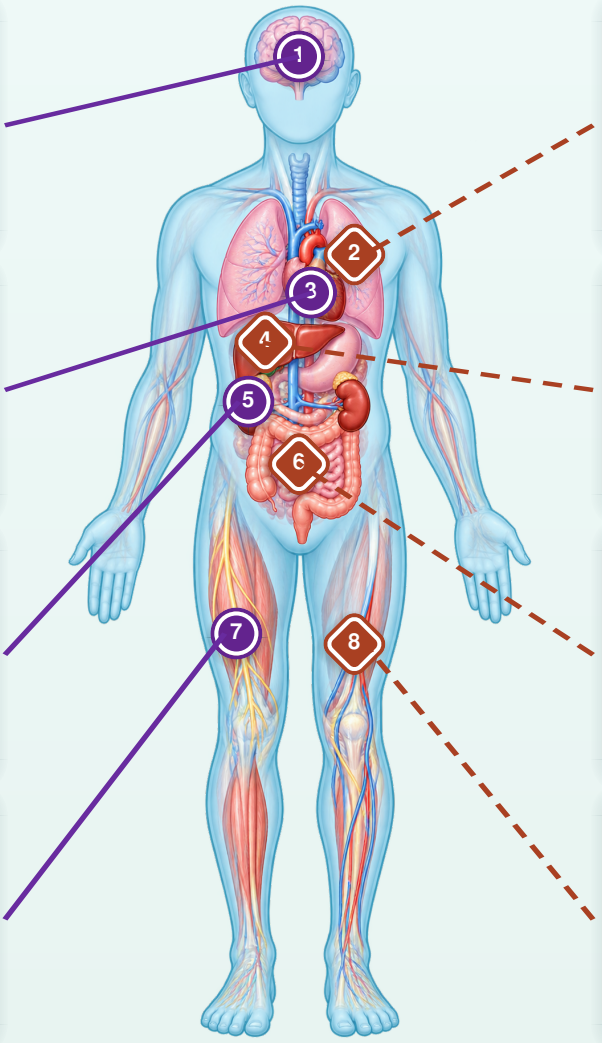
Pembrolizumab

Chest pain, racing heartbeat or fainting needs urgent assessment.

4 Liver

Pembrolizumab / paclitaxel

Yellow skin/eyes or dark urine; tests also check changes before symptoms.



5 Kidneys

Pembrolizumab / carboplatin

Report much less urine, swelling or persistent vomiting; kidney results affect treatment.

6 Bowel / mouth

Pembrolizumab / chemotherapy

New diarrhoea, severe tummy pain, mouth ulcers or inability to drink need advice.

7 Skin / nerves

Pembrolizumab / paclitaxel

Report rash, blisters, numbness, weakness or problems with balance or hand function.

8 Blood / infection

paclitaxel / carboplatin

Fever, shivers or suddenly feeling unwell: contact oncology immediately.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Use the oncology emergency instructions for fever, shivers or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. New cough/breathlessness, severe diarrhoea, reduced urine, confusion or severe rash need prompt advice. Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain, collapse or major bleeding need emergency help. Immune symptoms may start after treatment stops.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Pembrolizumab

- Immune inflammation of lungs, bowel, liver, kidneys, glands, skin and other organs
- Serious infusion reactions
- Effects can develop after treatment ends

Paclitaxel

- Low blood counts and infection
- Hair loss
- Numbness or tingling that may persist
- Muscle/joint aches
- Infusion reactions

Carboplatin

- Low blood counts, infection or bleeding
- Nausea and vomiting
- Allergic reactions
- Kidney, hearing and nerve effects

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Induction support

Anti-sickness medicines help with carboplatin. Paclitaxel premedication helps prevent infusion reactions. Ask for one clear steroid schedule and report infusion symptoms immediately.

Maintenance support

Chemotherapy and taxane premedication stop. Pembrolizumab alone usually does not need the same preventive anti-sickness medicines; ask for the updated prescription. Immune symptom vigilance continues.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00579/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.